

Civil Rights Hub - Development TODO

Last Updated: June 14, 2026

Project: <https://www.civilrightshub.org>

Goal: Make the platform truly beneficial to the public while building sustainable revenue to cover costs.

CRITICAL (Do First) - Empty States & Trust

- **Fix Attorney Directory** - Directory claims 1,756 attorneys but filters return empty. Investigate data loading bug or populate with real attorney data from public state bar databases.
- **Seed Violation Reports** - 0 reports in last 24h despite 1,342 total. Import recent public records (police misconduct databases, court filings, news reports) to show activity.
- **Populate FOIA Tracker** - Shows “No activity yet.” Add 5-10 example FOIA requests with realistic timelines so visitors understand the feature.
- **Fix Empty State UI** - Every tool showing “No results” needs a compelling empty state with: example data, CTA to add/contribute, explanation of what will appear.
- **Onboard Community Members** - Only 3 members visible. Invite attorneys, activists, and journalists to create profiles. Target 50+ members in first month.
- **Verify Location Fallback** - Non-US visitors see Jakarta with empty data. Add graceful fallback showing “US-focused platform” message with option to browse nationwide data.

HIGH PRIORITY (Credibility & Content)

- **Create /about Page** - Add mission, team (We The People News), story, impact metrics, funding transparency, and how to get involved.
- **Create /volunteer Page** - Formal volunteer program with roles: content contributors, legal researchers, community moderators, translators, developers.
- **Create /contribute Page** - How to contribute: submit violations, add attorneys, report scanner links, suggest content, donate.
- **Add Impact Section** - “X violations reported, Y attorneys connected, Z FOIA requests filed” live counters on homepage.
- **Newsroom Content Calendar** - Publish 2-3 articles weekly. Topics: state-by-state rights guides, recent court decisions, how-to guides, violation roundups.
- **Expand City Hubs** - Move beyond templated pages. Add local attorneys, local laws, recent local violations, local scanner links, local organizations per city.
- **Add Open Source Repo Link** - Link to GitHub repository in footer. Add CONTRIBUTING.md, good-first-issues, and project board.
- **Accessibility Audit** - Run WCAG 2.1 AA audit. Add screen reader labels, keyboard navigation, color contrast fixes, accessibility statement.
- **Add Newsletter Signup (No Auth Required)** - Email capture on homepage and footer. Weekly digest of violations, FOIA news, court watches.
- **Create “What to Expect” Guide** - Explain what happens when you report a violation, file a FOIA, or contact an attorney. Set expectations.

MEDIUM PRIORITY (Features & Growth)

- **Mobile App (PWA)** - Convert to Progressive Web App with push notifications for nearby violations/scanner alerts.
 - **Multilingual Support** - Start with Spanish (largest non-English US population). Add language switcher, translated rights guides.
 - **Attorney Verification System** - Badge system: verified bar membership, pro bono commitment, civil rights specialty.
 - **Violation Report Enhancement** - Photo/video upload, witness contact, follow-up timeline, anonymous reporting option.
 - **Scanner Feed Improvement** - Add favorites, local default based on location, incident type tagging, push notifications.
 - **Community Forum** - Discussions per state/city, Q&A with attorneys, incident coordination.
 - **Legal Document Templates** - Beyond FOIA: complaint templates, demand letters, small claims guides, records request letters.
 - **Know Your Rights Videos** - Short 60-second videos for each amendment and common scenarios (pulled over, at a protest, filming police).
 - **Podcast Integration** - Civil rights podcast directory or start a hub podcast.
 - **Emergency Hotline Integration** - Direct dial to ACLU hotlines, National Lawyers Guild, local legal aid.
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MONETIZATION (Sustainability)

Phase 1: Foundation (Month 1-2)

- **Apply for 501(c)(3)** - File IRS Form 1023-EZ for tax-exempt status. Enables tax-deductible donations and grants.
- **Google Ad Grants** - Apply for \$10K/month free Google Ads (\$120K/year equivalent). Requires 501(c)(3).
- **GitHub Sponsors** - Enable GitHub Sponsors on repository for developer donations.
- **Add Donation Wall** - Public thank-you page listing supporters (with permission). Recognition encourages giving.

Phase 2: Revenue (Month 2-6)

- **Foundation Grant Applications** - Target: Ford, MacArthur, Knight, Open Society, Mozilla, Democracy Fund. Hire grant writer if possible.
- **Patreon Tier Restructure** - Add tiers: \$3 (supporter), \$5 (insider - early access), \$10 (advocate - name on site), \$25 (champion - monthly call).
- **Merchandise Store** - Rights-themed items: "I Know My Rights" stickers, pocket constitution cards, protest safety guides, shirts. Use Printful/Printify (no inventory).
- **Amazon Affiliate Links** - Add to recommended books section, legal guides, equipment (body cams, etc.).

Phase 3: Scale (Month 6-12)

- **Data Licensing** - Offer anonymized aggregate data to researchers, journalists, policymakers. Fee-based API access.

- **Corporate Training** - “Civil Rights in the Workplace” training modules for HR/DEI teams. Fee-based virtual workshops.
 - **Legal Tech Partnerships** - Integration partnerships with case management tools, legal research platforms.
 - **Sponsored Resource Sections** - Clearly labeled sponsored content from vetted civil rights organizations.
 - **Premium Organization Accounts** - Bulk FOIA filing, analytics dashboards, team collaboration for law firms and newsrooms.
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TECHNICAL DEBT & INFRASTRUCTURE

- **SEO Optimization** - Meta tags, structured data (JSON-LD), sitemap.xml, robots.txt, Open Graph images, Twitter cards.
 - **Performance Audit** - Lighthouse score optimization. Target: 90+ on all metrics.
 - **Analytics Setup** - Privacy-respecting analytics (Plausible or Fathom). Public dashboard option.
 - **Error Monitoring** - Sentry or similar for production error tracking.
 - **Backup Strategy** - Automated database backups, disaster recovery plan.
 - **Rate Limiting** - Protect API endpoints from abuse.
 - **Content Moderation** - Flag/report system for violation reports and community content.
 - **Database Optimization** - Indexing, query optimization for attorney/violation searches.
 - **CDN Setup** - Cloudflare or similar for global performance and DDoS protection.
 - **SSL/Security Audit** - Regular security scans, dependency updates.
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MARKETING & OUTREACH

- **Social Media Presence** - Twitter/X, Instagram, TikTok, Bluesky, Mastodon. Daily rights tips, violation alerts, success stories.
 - **Press Kit** - One-page media kit with mission, stats, founder story, screenshots.
 - **Partner Outreach** - Contact ACLU chapters, NLG chapters, EFF, Reporters Committee for partnerships/links.
 - **University Outreach** - Law school clinics, journalism schools, political science departments.
 - **Reddit/Forum Presence** - r/civilrights, r/legaladvice, r/Bad_Cop_No_Donut, r/activism. Be helpful, not spammy.
 - **Email Outreach to Attorneys** - Invite civil rights attorneys to list themselves. Target: 500 verified attorneys in 6 months.
 - **Podcast Tour** - Founder appears on civil rights, legal, and civic tech podcasts.
 - **Conference Presence** - RightsCon, SXSW, Facing Race, NLG conventions.
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CONTENT CALENDAR (First 12 Weeks)

Week	Newsroom Articles	New Feature	Promotion
1-2	“Your Right to Film Police: 50-State Guide”, “What to Do If You’ re Arrested at a Protest”	Fix empty states	Social launch, Reddit AMA
3-4	“Understanding Qualified Immunity”, “FOIA 101: A Beginner’ s Guide”	Attorney verification	Email law schools
5-6	“State-by-State: Recording Police”, “Civil Rights at the Border”	City hub expansion	Partner with ACLU local
7-8	“How to Read a Police Report”, “Your Rights in a Traffic Stop”	Newsletter system	Podcast outreach
9-10	“Understanding Consent Decrees”, “Digital Privacy at Protests”	Spanish translation	Latino media outreach
11-12	“Civil Rights for Journalists”, “How to File a Civil Rights Complaint”	PWA launch	Conference submissions

SUCCESS METRICS (6-Month Targets)

Metric	Current	6-Month Target
Weekly violation reports	0-5	50+
Verified attorneys	~1,756 (but broken)	500+ verified
Active community members	3	500+
Newsletter subscribers	0	2,000+
Monthly unique visitors	Unknown	50,000+
FOIA requests filed	0 tracked	100+
City hub pages	18	50+
Monthly recurring donations	Unknown	\$2,000+
Grant funding secured	\$0	\$50K+

Prioritize ruthlessly. The most important things are: (1) fix empty states so the site looks alive, (2) add content so people have a reason to return, and (3) build community so the platform has network effect. Everything else can wait.